

Chapter 51-1

The cloth doll was covered in grime, even though Xu Qingzhu had already dusted off quite a bit.

When Liang Shi picked it up, she still got a handful of dust.

It was about the same size as ordinary plush toys that hang on school bags. Through the armpit area, one could vaguely see it was originally lotus pink in color. The facial features had been completely worn away, leaving only a grayish mess.

The needle insertions had no pattern whatsoever—over a dozen needles were densely packed into the small abdomen area.

One leg of the doll had already been torn open at the seams, revealing the cheap cotton stuffing inside.

Liang Shi examined the doll in her palm for a while, lowering her eyes as she pulled out the needles one by one.

They were all ordinary household embroidery needles.

Liang Shi had only seen such things in period dramas before.

She pulled out a total of 12 needles.

Liang Shi arranged them in a row on the bedside table, then looked at that button.

The button wasn't anything special—just an ordinary shirt button.

From its shape, it looked like a cuff button.

What was most distinctive was the bloodstains on the button. It wasn't the button's original red color or dyed pigment—it was blood-red.

It also looked like it had been there for some time.

Liang Shi wasn't a professional and couldn't determine how long the bloodstains on it had existed.

No one had expected to find such things in the room.

They looked quite eerie.

After a long silence, Liang Shi was the first to speak: "Where did you find these?"

Xu Qingzhu replied: "The doll was under the bed near the bedside table, in a very corner spot. This bed probably hasn't been changed—it's extremely dirty underneath, full of dust, looks like it hasn't been cleaned in ages. That button was behind the door, very similar in color to the floor tiles with their cracked pattern. It was probably missed during cleaning and left behind."

Hearing this, Liang Shi bent down and used her phone's flashlight to look under the bed. It was indeed as Xu Qingzhu had described—covered in dust.

The bed's quality wasn't good either. The wooden boards looked quite old. It was the mattress on top that was of good quality—it should be newly replaced and hadn't completely aired out yet.

She tried to find more things, but Xu Qingzhu said: "I've already looked everywhere. Just this doll—the rest is all dust."

Liang Shi swept around once more, then walked to behind the door.

The tiles behind the door were light red with some cracked texturing. When she held the button against the tile, it indeed couldn't be seen.

The discovery of the cloth doll and bloody button made both of them feel uneasy.

Especially since they had both seen that horrifying photograph before.

Although this room was now decorated in a fresh, light style, every spot seemed to correspond with the original layout.

The wind was strong outside, whooshing through the treetops.

Adding several degrees of eeriness.

Liang Shi stayed for a while, then asked gently: "Should we go home?"

Xu Qingzhu hesitated: "Wouldn't that be inappropriate?"

Qiu Zimin had just fainted from arguing with Liang Shi, and now so late at night, Liang Shi still wanted to return to Shallow Water Bay—it didn't look right no matter how you viewed it.

But Liang Shi stood up, took photos of the doll and the row of needles, found a transparent bag to put the bloody button in her pocket, got up and opened the door. Her gentle voice carried a hint of determination: "Let's go. We're going home."

She didn't want to stay in this room.

Xu Qingzhu had always been cautious—after finding that doll, she had taken photos.

On the way back, she sent them to Liang Shi.

Liang Shi chuckled softly: "You're more careful than me."

She had been so angry at the time that she had directly pulled out the needles.

Indeed, she should have left this "evidence" behind.

Xu Qingzhu was responsible for driving.

After the car had driven a distance, Liang Shi called Liang Xinzhou, saying she wanted some quiet time, so she was leaving the old residence first, and asked him not to worry.

Although she didn't want to mention Qiu Zimin, out of respect for Liang Xinzhou, Liang Shi still asked him to take good care of Qiu Zimin.

This night was destined to be sleepless.